

Mitsue Project — Stakeholders & Relations

Entity List

Core Team

Name	Role
Rob Oudendijk	Founder & Project Lead (Dutch, resident Sugano since 2012)
Japanese Co-founder	TBD — top priority hire; rural-credible, Japanese-speaking
Mitsue Project (御杖プロジェクト)	Primary project entity (一般社団法人 → NPO法人)
YR-Design	Rob's company; project affiliation
Safecast	Citizen science network; philosophical foundation & open-data model

Advisors

Name	Role
Joi Ito	Former MIT Media Lab Director; AI policy advisor to Japanese government; member of METI AI Strategy Council & Digital Agency advisory bodies; deep connections across Japanese tech, government, and philanthropy circles; confirmed May 5 2026
Ray Ozzie	Creator of Lotus Notes; former Microsoft CSA; confirmed May 5 2026

Local Stakeholders

Name	Role
Mitsue Village Mayor	Primary government contact
Mitsue Village Vice Mayor	Initial informal contact (met late 2025)
自治会 Leaders (Sugano + hamlets)	Community associations; trust-building target
Private Mountain Landowners	Sugi forest owners; harvesting partnership targets
Local Forestry Group	Early consultation partner (met early 2026)
Mitsue Elementary School	Closed building; central project asset

Government — Local & Regional

Name	Role
Mitsue Village Government	Primary stakeholder; letter of interest target
Nara Prefecture	Regional oversight; potential grant source

Government — National (Grants, Permissions & Policy)

Ministry / Agency	Grants / Funding	Permissions / Regulation	Notes
METI (経済産業省)	Green tech subsidies; data center incentives	FIT/FIP registration; 電気事業法 (power generation licensing)	Key funder for energy transition & AI infrastructure
NEDO	Renewable energy R&D grants; rural energy resilience and EV infrastructure grants	—	Arm of METI; major R&D grant source
林野庁 (Forestry Agency)	Forestry subsidies; reforestation grants	伐採届出 (cutting notification); Forest Act compliance	Critical for forest restoration and legal timber sourcing
Cabinet Office (内閣府)	地方創生 regional revitalization grants (¥5–50M)	—	Digital Garden City Nation Initiative policy driver
総務省 (MIC — Ministry of Internal Affairs)	Rural broadband subsidies; data center regional grants	Telecom regulation; municipal digital policy	Funds rural fiber; connected to Digital Garden City strategy
デジタル庁 (Digital Agency)	Digital transformation grants for rural areas	Digital infrastructure standards	Joi Ito has advisory connections here; aligned with project's rural digital mission
環境省 (Ministry of Environment)	Carbon credit support	J-Credit certification; environmental impact assessment (環境アセスメント)	Governs J-Credit scheme for forest carbon offsets
JST (Japan Science and Technology Agency)	R&D grants for green tech & AI	—	Potential Phase 2–3 R&D co-funding
農業委員会 (Agricultural Commission)	—	Land use permits if agricultural land involved	Local body; Nara Prefecture jurisdiction

Ministry / Agency	Grants / Funding	Permissions / Regulation	Notes
Legal Affairs Bureau (法務局)	—	Corporate registration (一般社団法人)	One-time registration

Diplomatic

Name	Role
Kingdom of the Netherlands	Rob's origin; diplomatic backing

Foundations

Name	Tier	Role
Nippon Foundation (日本財団)	Primary	Social challenge grants; Asia's largest grantmaker
Japan Fund for Global Environment	Primary	Environmental conservation grants
Toyota Foundation	Secondary	Community & rural projects
MacArthur Foundation	Stretch	Through Joi Ito network
Rockefeller Foundation	Stretch	Through Joi Ito network

Japanese Corporates (potential partners)

Name	Angle
NTT	Fiber connectivity; data center consultation (critical contact)
SoftBank	Data center partnership
Sumitomo Forestry (住友林業)	Forestry expertise & capital
Mitsui Bussan (三井物産)	Trading company; forestry supply chain
Hitachi	Industrial / infrastructure

Dutch Corporates (potential partners)

Name	Angle
Philips	CSR; Dutch presence in Japan
ASML	CSR; Dutch presence in Japan
Royal HaskoningDHV	Water & infrastructure engineering
Arcadis	Sustainability & climate consulting

Name	Angle
Heineken	CSR; Dutch presence in Japan

Legal & Professional Support (to hire)

Role	Timing
行政書士 (Administrative Scrivener)	Phase 0-1; permits, NPO setup, grants
公認会計士 / 税理士 (Accountant / Tax)	Phase 1; accounting system, tax registration
弁護士 (Lawyer)	Phase 1-2; landowner contracts

Relationship Flowchart



